

USB Device threat assessment and security controls

1. Project description

This project focused on evaluating the security risks associated with unknown USB devices and USB baiting attacks. I analyzed a scenario involving a USB drive found in hospital parking lot and assessed the types of sensitive information stored on the device. The project included identifying potential attack methods, evaluating how threat actors could exploit the information, and recommending security controls to reduce organizational risk.

2. Skills demonstrated

- risk assessment
- Security awareness
- Social engineering analysis
- Threat identification
- Endpoint security
- Security controls evaluation
- Security policy awareness
- Incident prevention

3. Key activities

- examined the content of an unknown USB device
- Identified personally identifiable information (PII) and operational data
- Evaluated how attackers could use discovered information for phishing and social engineering attacks
- Assessed organizational risks related to removable media
- Recommended administrative, operational, and technical security controls
- Analyzed USB baiting as a common social engineering technique

4. Outcome

This project strengthened my understanding of removable media security risks, social engineering tactics, and security control implementation. It demonstrated how organizations can reduce exposure to USB-based attacks through employee awareness programs, endpoint security configurations, and established incident response procedures.